

Opera comes to Maemo

Developers were working on Opera Mini for the Nokia Maemo platform in their free time

Corsair sells SSDs

Corsair to launch Force line of SSDs; read speeds of 285MB/s and write speeds of 275MB/s expected

stand out in a crowd, and its widescreen and playback quality will give you a great video viewing experience. Call clarity is quite good, though the loudspeaker volume could be higher. Sound quality is surprisingly good, though the bass is lacking, which can be expected with just one small speaker located with the earpiece. Also to be noted is the voice recording, which with two microphones delivers excellent audio clarity in recorded video as well. Head-to-head with the Omnia II, the biggest difference you'll notice will be the Chocolate's better video playback quality, which doesn't show the dithering/banding of the Windows Mobile phone and its 65K colour limitation.

Multimedia phones (25,001 to 32,000)

This category features some of the best known phones in the market, and consists of some flagship devices. Ranging from Nokia to Samsung and LG to Sony Ericsson, the competition is intense here. Most of the phones feature large screens: many are touchscreens, and some, like the Sony Ericsson Aino and W995, are keypad based.

Nokia N97 Mini

How does the N97 Mini differ from the N97? It's smaller (display, dimensions, battery) and lighter (weight,

internal memory), features a metallic battery cover, and does not feature a D-pad, lens cover, or FM transmitter. Despite all this, the N97 Mini remains virtually identical to its bigger brother in terms of interface and functions. Anybody who is used to a S60 touch-enabled device will be at home with this phone.

The phone's interface is easy to use and the resistive touchscreen is responsive (supporting both stylus and gloves), featuring adjustable haptic feedback. The call/terminate keys are also touch-sensitive, and kinetic scrolling is available. The proximity sensor takes care of locking the screen and keys during a call, while the accelerometer also silences a call when the phone is flipped. The screen also has great contrast in sunlight. The sliding three-row QWERTY keyboard snaps open readily, and the quality of the buttons and feedback is great. It's easy to use, and numbers can be easily accessed with the modifier key. An on-screen alphanumeric keyboard is also available in portrait mode. The handwriting recognition works very well, with even my not so good handwriting being translated. It comes with a training option to teach the handset your unique handwriting.

While it only has a 434MHz CPU and 128 MB of RAM, it manages not to be slow in routine tasks. Call clarity is good all around, though the loudspeaker and handset could do with some boosts in volume though.



Nokia N97 Mini

Verdict

Feature rich, fast, and capable, the N97 Mini is the top performer in the category. And being a top-end phone from Nokia, you cannot expect to find much wrong with the device. It is perfect for those who want to enjoy a large touchscreen screen along with a full QWERTY keyboard on the Symbian platform. The lack of DivX playback should be mentioned however, as well as the lack of free office document editing. The much cheaper Nokia 5800 Xpress Music is also an option, sporting a similar Series 60 interface, only without a QWERTY keyboard.

LG GC900 Viewty Smart

The Viewty Smart is definitely a cameraphone, and earns its 'smart' moniker with intelligent camera options such as smart multiple face detection, sensor for scene analysis and image optimisation, and multiple shot modes.

Not much separates this phone from the LG BL40 Chocolate,

very solid build of the BL40 Chocolate, mainly because of its flimsy back button, however useful it might be. The screen is not as bright as the Chocolate either, and has serious legibility issues in sunlight. Also missing is the 3.5mm jack, and the standard microUSB port, replaced with a proprietary one.

Ergonomically, the phone fits well onto the palm, and fits easily into the pocket, with the side buttons (cube view/task manager on the left, volume and camera on the right) within easy finger reach. The camera button requires to be held for about 5 seconds before switching you to camera mode, and this is quite an annoying delay. The capacitive touchscreen shares the same faults as the Chocolate, owing to the common S-Class UI, and is not as responsive as desired

LG GC900 Viewty Smart



late, featuring the same S-Class UI (the first Viewty with it) that's arranged in pretty much the same way, and the same power/lock button. The main differences are in the physical back button, the 8MP camera, the 720p video recording, and unfortunately, in the build quality, where the Viewty racks up as clunky compared to the

in most scenarios, except at scrolling and in Cube view. The accelerometer is not as scarily sensitive, though it does take its own sweet time to auto-rotate.

The S-Class interface here offers four homescreens and a cube view, just like the Chocolate, but here, the four are: Widget, Multimedia, Contacts, and Shortcuts; with Multi-